

Pegu range or Pegu Yoma is a series of low mountains region between the Irrawaddy and the Sittaung rivers in Myanmar. Oil and natural gas, coal, etc. feature prominently in Myanmar's wealth of natural resources. Mineral oil is an important mineral of the Pegu Yoma region of Myanmar.

ix. The Uranium

*Uranium was discovered in 1789 by Martin Klaproth. It is extracted from an ore named Pitchblende. Uranium and Thorium are two important sources of atomic power. *According to the figures of World Mineral Production Data 2018-22, in the year 2022, **Kazakhstan** is the leading producer of Uranium in the world followed by **Namibia, Canada, Australia and Uzbekistan. India is the 9th largest country in Uranium production**. *Australia has the **largest uranium reserve** in the world. *The **Cigar Lake mine** of Canada is the mine with the largest production of Uranium situated in a single place. Olympic Dam mine situated in Australia. *Uranium is extracted from the Sinkolobwe mine located in Katanga region in the country of Democratic Republic of the Congo. Uranium City is located in Canada. It is located on the Northern shores of Lake Athabasca. *Other important reserves of Uranium in the world are Port Radium and Elliot Lake of Canada, Colorado Plateau of USA, **Radium Hill** and **Marry Katheline** of Australia. *Radium is a radioactive chemical element. It is extracted from the ore of Uranium, which is **Pitchblende**.

*The maximum known quantity of **Thorium** has been found in the coastal beach sand of Kerala (India) and from the eastern coast of Brazil, especially from the **Espirito Santo region**. Thorium is also found in the southeastern and Western mountains regions of USA, Nigeria, South Africa Union, Russian Federation and Indonesia (Sumatra).

1. The leading producer of Uranium in the world is –

- (a) Australia (b) Canada
(c) Kazakhstan (d) India

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

According to the World Minerals Production data 2018-22, in the year 2022, presently Kazakhstan is the largest producer of Uranium (2022). Namibia and Canada are in 2nd and 3rd place respectively. Notably, prior to 2009, Canada was the leading producer of Uranium.

2. Which one of the following is a prominent Uranium producer ?

- (a) U.S.A. (b) Canada (c) Germany (d) Zambia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Which of the following countries is the biggest producer of Atomic Minerals in the world ?

- (a) Russia (b) China (c) U.S.A. (d) Canada

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

4. The largest reserves of Uranium are found in –

- (a) Canada (b) Australia
(c) South Africa (d) Brazil

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Australia's Uranium reserves are the world's largest reserves (in 2022), with the Olympic Dam Mine situated in South Australia.

5. Which one of the following countries is credited with the establishment of 'Uranium City' ?

- (a) Australia (b) Canada (c) Russia (d) U.S.A.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Uranium City is a northern settlement in Saskatchewan, Canada. It is located near the north shore of Lake Athabasca, in Canada.

6. Radium is extracted from the mines of –

- (a) Limestone (b) Pitchblende
(c) Rutile (d) Hematite

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Radium is a radioactive element with symbol Ra. It is extracted from Uranium ore Pitchblende.

7. Which one of the following countries is known for very important uranium ore deposits ?

- (a) Canada (b) China (c) Pakistan (d) Zaire

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Among the given options, Canada is known for Uranium deposits. Presently Australia has the biggest reserve of Uranium.

8. Which one of the following countries is the largest producer of uranium in the world ?

- (a) Kazakhstan (b) Canada
(c) Australia (d) France
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)